

## ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

### PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a magazine article about IT security:

#### Protecting yourself from cyber crime

How good is your online IT security? Experts say Hong Kong netizens do not do enough to protect themselves against cyber crimes. Cyber crimes could be identity theft, loss of ATM or bank passwords, or even financial losses when criminals use your account to buy expensive things online! According to the government, the number of reported cyber crimes in Hong Kong in 2009 was 1,506, but it had risen to 2,206 by 2011.

These statistics are unsurprising. Some of the world's 25 most common passwords in 2012 were 'password', '123456', 'abc123', and even 'monkey'! Experts say passwords like these – which are so easy to guess – make a cyber criminal's job even easier, allowing them to steal vital personal information by breaking into users' accounts. Additionally, people do not change their passwords regularly because they think it is hard to remember a long or unique password.

Experts suggest the following steps to protect yourself from cyber crime:

1. Never use public computers to access emails or bank accounts because there could be a 'virus' installed to copy your password(s).
2. Never use the same password for all, or most of, your online accounts.
3. Never store important information, such as passwords, on your mobile phone.
4. Change your passwords regularly.
5. Set complex passwords.

As members of your school's Computer Club, your group needs to give a presentation about cyber crime. Discuss with your group what to include in your presentation. You may want to talk about:

- why cyber crimes occur
- the importance of protecting ourselves from cyber crimes
- ways to protect ourselves from cyber crimes
- anything else you think is important

### PART B Individual Response

1. Do you change your password regularly?
2. Do you use different passwords for all your email accounts?
3. Do you have difficulty remembering your passwords?
4. Have you shared your passwords with anyone before?
5. Would you tell your parents the password to your email account?
6. Do you think it is safe to buy things online?
7. Should schools invest more money in developing good IT security?
8. Do you think cyber crime is a serious offence?

DO NOT TAKE AWAY